

Michael Inouye. The popularity of 3-D movies has been a primary driver. TV makers are looking for differentiation and a reason for premium pricing. With some of the biggest-selling movies in 3-D, and customers willing to pay more for the experience, they saw an opportunity to bring that experience to the home.

Digital set-top box sales to hit 226 million

According to ABI Research, the worldwide market for digital set-top boxes—including hard-to-track free-to-air (FTA) satellite boxes—will grow from 205 million in 2010 to 226 million in 2015.

Sales in North America and Western Europe are falling following successful digital transitions, while Asia-Pacific, Latin America and Eastern Europe all are seeing significant growth. Digital terrestrial boxes are growing the fastest worldwide as Asia-Pacific and Latin American countries move through their digital transitions and toward analogue shutoff of broadcasts.

Media tablets may cannibalise mini notebooks

Driven by sales of the iPad, worldwide media tablet sales to end users will reach 19.5 million units in 2010, according to Gartner. These are poised for strong growth with worldwide end-user sales projected to total 54.8 million units in 2011—up 181 per cent from 2010—and surpass 208 million units in 2014.

Gartner analysts said the impact of media tablets on other devices will vary among segments. "The all-in-one nature of media tablets will result in the cannibalisation of other consumer electronics devices such as e-readers, gaming devices and media players," said Carolina Milanese, research vice president at Gartner. "Mini notebooks will suffer from the strongest cannibalisation threat as media tablet average selling prices drop below \$300 over the next two years."

Cellular M2M shows steady growth

Cellular machine-to-machine (M2M) connections continue to show steady



Canon India's senior vice president Alok Bharadwaj launching the company's new product range

growth, and are expected to exceed 297 million in 2015. In the latest update to ABI Research's forecasts, the 2009 forecast of about 225 million connections by 2014 has also been raised to 232.5 million. Within this worldwide picture, however, there are many regional differences. Europe will continue to account for the largest regional share with 110 million connections in 2015, North America will rank second with 79 million and the Asia-Pacific region third with almost 66 million.

The European market is the most diversified and has the most mature deployments. The EU benefits from regulatory mandates surrounding eCall and smart energy. In North America, the focus has traditionally been more on telematics, although M2M is now growing strongly in other areas including smart energy. Both telematics and energy are providing impetus in Asia-Pacific, but the markets are less mature outside of key countries such as Japan. Key operators providing M2M in Asia are NTT DoCoMo in Japan, Korea Telecom and China Mobile.

India shifting to greener economy

By 2030, India will spend \$2.3 trillion to boost its energy sector by expanding the country's energy basket to include green sources such as solar, wind and nuclear power. The effort is likely to help improve India's energy efficiency.

B.K. Chaturvedi, a member of the Planning Commission that charts India's growth path, said, "Being the world's third-worst carbon emitter, it is essential for the country to shift to a greener economy."

Last year, India had set a goal for slowing the growth of its emissions, saying it will try to contain its carbon intensity—the amount of carbon dioxide emitted per unit of GDP—by 20 to 25 per cent by 2020, from 2005 levels.

Panasonic launches 'go green' initiative

Panasonic has initiated a nationwide environment-sensitisation programme across 100 schools that will encourage and engage young minds to contribute towards a greener tomorrow. The programme, called 'Ecos' Kool,' will continue till February 2011. A pilot programme across seven schools has successfully concluded as part of phase I.

Said Arjun Balakrishnan, director-operations and planning, Panasonic India, "Through this programme, we hope to create awareness about environmental issues in the present-day scenario and ways to curtail the same amongst the youth in a fun-filled and engaging manner."

Canon rolls out 22 new products

In the second product launch of the year just before Diwali, Canon India